



Attention grabber

Ouranosaurus's sail was made of bones that grew out of its spine. Recent research has shown that younger individuals had small sails that grew to full size as the creature aged. This has led paleontologists to believe that the sail was probably used for display, helping larger, older individuals attract mates.

Clawed forelimb

SUPER SAIL

OURANOSAURUS

This Early Cretaceous giant spent a lot of time browsing on vegetation near rivers in what is now Niger in West Africa. *Ouranosaurus*'s hooflike middle fingers and strong wrist bones suggest that it walked on all fours, but it may have reared up on its hind limbs to reach food or to pick up speed. When its fossils were first studied in 1976, paleontologists couldn't agree on the function of *Ouranosaurus*'s large back sail. Suggested uses range from the control of body temperature to the storage of fat. Scientists are still unsure of its function today.